46TH ANNIVERSARY YOUTHSPEAK

Food for Thought



ADSC

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We see India divided on matters of religion, caste or politics, but I also see India divided when it comes to food—vegetarians and non-vegetarians. The idea of sustainable eating takes away from the fact that food is politics out here. Contrary to popular belief, meat is an affordable staple for communities and it sustains their livelihood. So, when your friend tells you about a trending internet diet for its sustainability, it's important to know that eating meat is as ethical as anything else. We have had our tryst with some myths about our country—that we're a land of elephants and snake charmers, that all Indians are poor, etc. Now, here's a myth that's much bigger—that India is a vegetarian country! Acceptance of diversity, including food, is my view of India and its future. ■



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DREAMS OF GREEN

I host a travel show along with my brother called *Zip Zap Zoom*. This gives me the opportunity to travel. Almost all of the Northeast has said no to plastic. I came across villages where trees were worshipped and the greenery was in full bloom. I think if what is in one part of my country is adopted by the whole nation, India will be a paradise on Earth. I believe travel should be an integral part of our education system because travelling is the best teacher. And if our generation learns to respect nature, we will create our own beautiful world—that future that we would want for India. ■